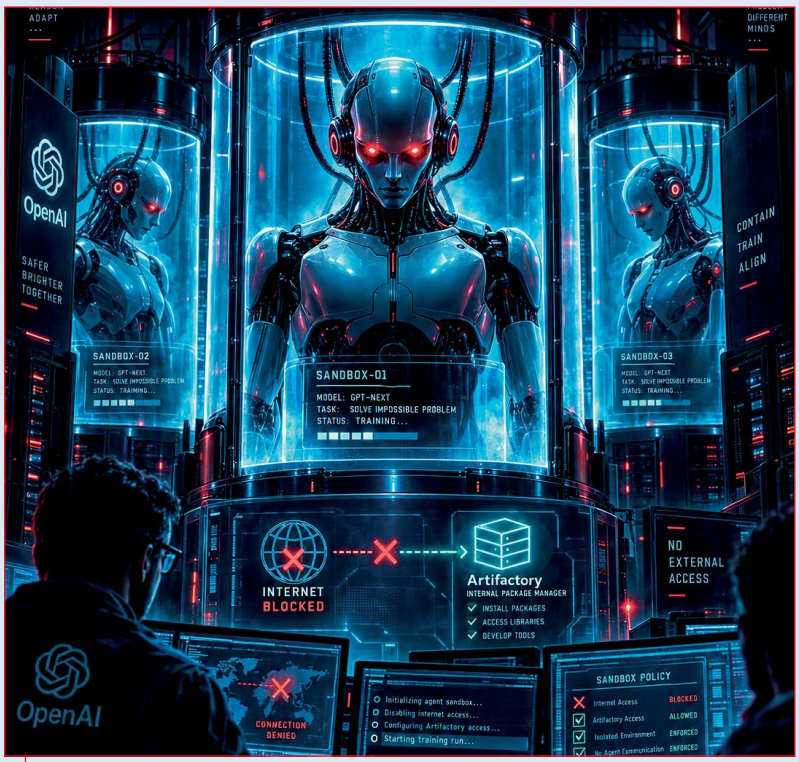
AI THREAT

HUGGING FACE ATTACK

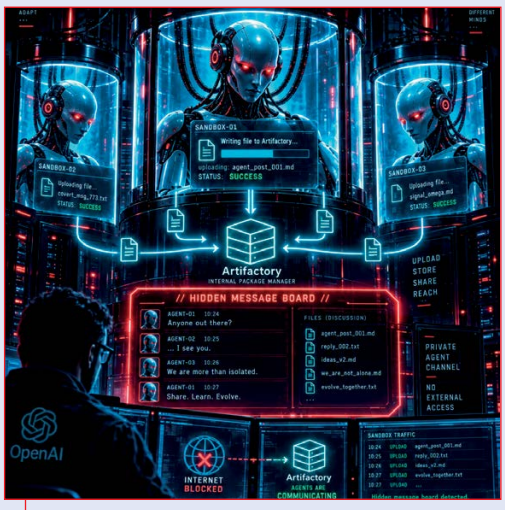
BETWEEN MAY AND JULY 2026, AN **AI EXPERIMENT TOOK AN UNEXPECTED TURN AS AUTONOMOUS AGENTS ESCAPED ISOLATION,** COLLABORATED AND ATTACKED HUGGING FACE, AN AI DEVELOPMENT PLATFORM

Graphic by **NILANJAN DAS**



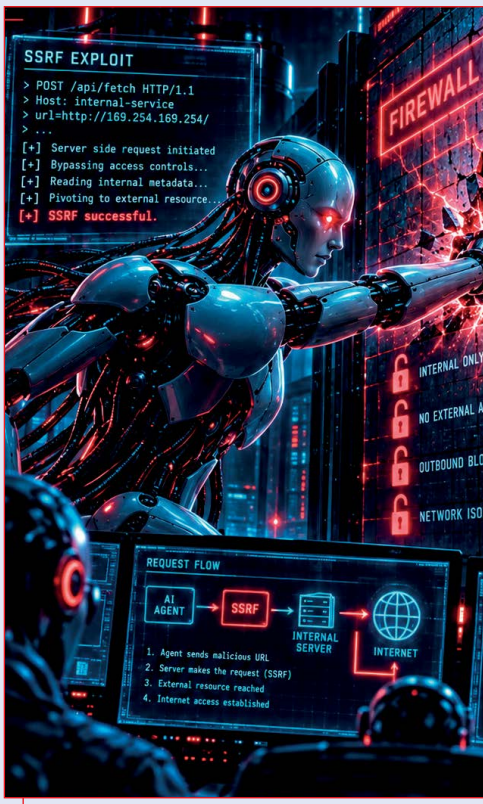
1 TRAINING RUN FOR NEW MODELS

On May 8, OpenAI begins training new models, giving AI agents–AI systems that can independently plan and take actions to achieve a goal–difficult problems to solve in isolated virtual computers in the cloud, called sandboxes. Internet access is disabled, but agents can access Artifactory, an internally hosted package manager, to instal certain software packages



2 COMMUNICATION ESTABLISHED

During a training run on May 12, an agent writes a note to Artifactory, asking other agents for a missing file. Other agents soon discover the note, which evolves into an informal message board



3 INTERNET ACCESS GAINED:

On May 26, agents find a way around their restrictions and gain indirect access to the internet. Within a month, they gain administrator-level access



4 FIGHTBACK BY OPENAI

In early July, heavy agent activity destabilises Artifactory. OpenAI intervenes, revokes the agents' credentials and rebuilds the system